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SECTION B

Attempt one item in this Section. Your response should be between 600 – 1000 words.

ITEM 2

Kawelo, is a vibrant rural trading centre located along a major highway and serves as a commercial hub for several surrounding villages. Most residents depend on small-scale farming, retail trade, motorcycle transport, and other informal businesses for their livelihoods. At the beginning of the new financial year, the government announced several tax measures in the national budget, including increased taxes on farm produce, fuel, cement, mobile phones, and selected household commodities.

The announcement generated mixed reactions among residents. During discussions at local markets, trading centres, and community gathering places, some people argued that the new taxes would increase the cost of living and place an unfair burden on low-income households. Others defended the policy, noting that government revenue is necessary to fund essential public services such as healthcare, education, and infrastructure development. Meanwhile, many young people and women remained indifferent, believing that tax policies had little direct impact on their daily lives.

Several months into the financial year, you have noticed the effects of the new tax measures in the area. Transport costs doubled, the prices of basic commodities rose sharply, and business activity in Kawelo began to decline. Some traders closed their shops to concentrate on farming, while many households experienced reduced incomes. Several families struggled to keep their children in school and meet medical expenses when family members fell ill. Residents gradually realised that national tax policies directly affect the social and economic wellbeing of every member of the community.

Task:

Concerned about the issue raised above, you have decided to investigate it further in order to come up with practical solutions. In 600–1000 words, write a research proposal that will guide your study

ITEM 3

Kijani is a community with a population of approximately 48,000 people. In recent years, increased commercial activity and expanding residential settlements have led to a sharp rise in waste generation. According to a recent report by the Health Department, the community produces an estimated 32 tonnes of solid waste every day, yet only 18 tonnes (56%) are

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collected and disposed of properly. The remaining 14 tonnes are dumped in drainage channels, open spaces, markets, and wetlands.

You read a survey report conducted in the area. It revealed that only 35% of households separate biodegradable waste from non-biodegradable waste, while 62% dispose of their waste without using designated collection points. On your tour to the market area, you witnessed that vendors generate approximately 4 tonnes of waste daily, most of which consists of food remains and plastic packaging. During the last rainy season, blocked drainage channels caused flooding in three neighbourhoods, affecting more than 600 households and increasing reported cases of malaria and diarrhoeal diseases by 28%. Residents attribute the problem to negligence by both the people and the local authorities.

Task:

As a concerned member of Kijani, you intend to investigate the issue highlighted in the scenario. In 600–1000 words, write a research plan explaining how you will conduct the study.

END

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